

Farid Talebloo

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 13+ years of experience designing and owning end-to-end batch ETL pipelines, data ingestion, and data quality frameworks at scale. Deep hands-on expertise with Snowflake (7+ yrs), Apache Airflow (7+ yrs), and cloud data services (AWS, Azure). Proven ability to navigate messy, legacy financial data sources and deliver clean, reliable, production-grade pipelines from scratch. Experienced in financial services domains (banking, insurance, mortgage). Hands-on LLM experience building production AI pipelines. Comfortable with full-cycle ownership including CI/CD, observability, and incident response in greenfield, startup-like environments. MSc in Machine Learning & AI (4.0 GPA).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data Engineering	Batch ETL Pipelines, Data Ingestion, Data Quality, Schema & Domain Mapping, Data Architecture, Data Modeling, Unstructured/Semi-structured Data (Excel, CSV, JSON)
Orchestration & Ingestion	Apache Airflow (7+ yrs), Fivetran, Apache Spark, PySpark
Data Platforms	Snowflake (7+ yrs), Databricks (Delta Lake, Spark SQL), PostgreSQL
Cloud Services	AWS (S3, Redshift, Glue, Lambda, CloudWatch, EMR, Athena), Azure (ADLS, ADF, Azure ML, Azure AI)
AI / LLM	LLM Pipelines (3+ yrs), GenAI, Deep Learning (PyTorch, TensorFlow), NLP, Prompt Engineering, Model Fine-tuning Support
DevOps / MLOps	Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, MLflow, Terraform, Monitoring & Alerting, Observability, Incident Response
Languages	Python (advanced), SQL (12+ yrs), PySpark, Spark SQL, C#
Practices	Data Quality Checks, Data Monitoring & Alerting, Documentation Standards, Pipeline Reliability, Agile (Scrum, Kanban)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Data Engineer / Engineering Manager Jan 2022 – Present

Avenue Living Asset Management, Calgary, Canada

- Designed and built batch ETL pipelines from scratch on Snowflake and Airflow, ingesting data from legacy sources including Excel, SmartSheet, and internal financial systems
- Led domain and schema mapping efforts translating complex, legacy real estate financial data models into clean, structured Snowflake schemas
- Implemented data monitoring, data quality checks, and alerting across all pipelines
- Architected cloud data lake on AWS S3 with Glue and Athena for ad-hoc analytics on semi-structured data
- Established data engineering best practices, documentation standards, and pipeline reliability frameworks for the team
- Built LLM-powered classification pipeline processing 10,000+ daily records with full CI/CD, observability, and quality gates
- Deployed LSTM deep learning pricing model (PyTorch) with end-to-end ownership from design through production monitoring
- Owned full-cycle delivery including CI/CD pipelines, Docker/Kubernetes deployment, monitoring, and incident response — no dedicated SRE/QA teams
- Led greenfield data platform build from ground zero, making architecture decisions and contributing proactively across the stack
- Managed a diverse team of data scientists, engineers, and analysts with Agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban)

Senior Data Engineer

Feb 2020 – Dec 2021

Calgary Homeless Foundation, Calgary, Canada

- Designed and built batch ETL pipelines on Snowflake and Airflow ingesting messy, semi-structured social services data from legacy sources

- Led schema mapping and data normalization for complex, unstructured data formats including Excel and CSV
- Implemented data quality monitoring, alerting, and documentation standards from scratch
- Managed cloud data storage on AWS S3 and Azure ADLS with access controls and lifecycle policies
- Established pipeline reliability frameworks in a greenfield environment with full-cycle ownership

Machine Learning Researcher

Jan 2020 – Dec 2021

University of Calgary, Calgary, Canada

- Designed ML experiments and built proofs of concept with rigorous validation methodology
- Published peer-reviewed research on optimization methods with practical AI/ML implementation

Lead Data Engineer

2017 – 2019

MCI Telecommunications, Tehran, Iran

- Designed and operated batch ETL pipelines on Snowflake and Airflow at enterprise scale, ingesting and normalizing data across customer, billing, and operational domains handling billions of records
- Led domain and schema mapping translating complex legacy telecom data models into clean, structured pipelines
- Built data lake infrastructure on AWS S3 with Redshift for analytics and Glue for ETL transformations
- Implemented data quality standards, monitoring, and alerting frameworks across all production pipelines
- Established documentation standards and pipeline reliability practices for the engineering team
- Collaborated with backend and infrastructure engineers ensuring tight integration with platform architecture

Data Engineer

Jun 2015 – Mar 2017

Export Development Bank of Iran (EDBI), Tehran, Iran

- Built batch ETL pipelines for regulated banking data with strict compliance, auditability, and data quality requirements
- Navigated messy financial data sources including legacy banking systems, Excel, and unstructured formats
- Implemented data quality checks, monitoring, and master data management for financial reporting
- Domain expertise in financial services: banking, insurance, trade finance, and regulatory reporting

Technical Instructor

Sep 2012 – Mar 2018

Kahkeshan Noor Institute, Tehran, Iran

- Trained 500+ professionals in SQL, data engineering, data modeling, and analytics

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Software Engineering

Jan 2020 – Jan 2022

University of Calgary — GPA: 4.0 — Specialization: Machine Learning & AI

Bachelor of Science, Information Technology Engineering

2005 – 2009

University of Sufi Razi, Zanzan, Iran — GPA: 3.8

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102) — 2023
- Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900) — 2023
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Developer (MCSD): Application Builder — 2016

KEY PROJECTS

- **Greenfield ETL Platform (Avenue Living):** Designed and built entire batch ETL infrastructure from scratch — Snowflake, Airflow, cloud storage (AWS/Azure), data quality monitoring, alerting, and CI/CD — with full-cycle ownership
- **LLM Classification Pipeline:** Built production GenAI pipeline processing 10,000+ records/day from messy financial data with observability and quality gates
- **Legacy Financial Data Normalization:** Led schema mapping of complex legacy financial data models (Excel, SmartSheet, internal systems) into clean Snowflake schemas
- **Enterprise Data Lake (MCI Telecom):** Architected S3-based data lake with Redshift and Glue handling billions of records with monitoring and reliability frameworks
- **Banking Data Pipelines (EDBI):** Built compliant ETL pipelines for regulated financial services with

audit trails and quality checks

DOMAIN EXPERTISE

Financial Services (Banking, Insurance, Mortgage/Real Estate Finance) — Telecommunications — Social Services

LANGUAGES

English (Professional Fluency) — Persian (Native) — Arabic (Conversational) — German (Basic)